

One Wrong Move: Lower-Is-Better Scoring Report

Report 006 generated May 2, 2026 in `/Users/kevinhegg/Desktop/one-wrong-move`.

Final Response / Summary

Changed One Wrong Move from an abstract high-score display to a lower-is-better time score. The timer behavior remains active-solving-only. Completion and share text now show final score seconds, lower-is-better copy, base rounded-up time, and the 10-second-per-mistake penalty.

Repo State Summary

- `pwd : /Users/kevinhegg/Desktop/one-wrong-move`
- Initial branch: `puzzle-pool-and-pauses`
- Current branch: `scoring-lower-is-better`
- Remote: `origin git@github.com:KevinHegg/one-wrong-move.git`
- Nested git directories: `./.git` only
- Checkpoint commit: `0a4edf5` Add puzzle pool and paused round flow

Files Created Or Changed

- `public/index.html`
- `public/style.css`
- `public/game.js`
- `public/scoring.js`
- `scripts/validate-scoring.js`
- `README.md`
- `docs/game-design.md`
- `docs/codex-reports/screenshots/006-*.png`
- `docs/codex-reports/006-lower-is-better-scoring-report.pdf`

Old Scoring Problem

The prior UI showed a high number such as 934. That read like arbitrary arcade scoring, and players could not immediately tell what changed their result.

New Scoring Formula

```
baseSeconds = Math.ceil(totalActiveMs / 1000)
mistakePenaltySeconds = mistakes * 10
scoreSeconds = baseSeconds + mistakePenaltySeconds
```

The score is shown in seconds. Lower is better. Mistakes add time so accuracy matters without creating an opaque ranking.

Worked Examples

Active Time	Mistakes	Base	Penalty	Final Score
18.2s	2	19s	20s	39s
59.999s	3	60s	30s	90s

Validation Results

- `node --check public/scoring.js`: passed.
- `node --check public/game.js`: passed.
- `node --check scripts/validate-scoring.js`: passed.
- `node scripts/validate-scoring.js`: Validated lower-is-better scoring cases.
- `node scripts/validate-puzzles.js`: Validated 1200 daily rounds across 100 dates and 7 puzzle types.
- `git diff --check`: passed.
- PASS: Intro explains scoring briefly
- PASS: Timer is stopped on intro
- PASS: Round briefing keeps board hidden and timer stopped
- PASS: Timer starts only after Start Round
- PASS: Wrong tap increases mistake count and timer keeps running
- PASS: Correct tap pauses timer
- PASS: Completion screen shows lower-is-better score breakdown
- PASS: No abstract high-score display remains
- PASS: Share text uses lower-is-better score
- PASS: Score formula matches snapshot
- PASS: Play another mix starts a replay variant
- PASS: Variant completion still works with lower-is-better score
- PASS: Fresh browser console has no errors

Local Run Instructions

```
python3 -m http.server 8080 -d public
```

Then open `http://127.0.0.1:8080/`. The app also opens directly from `public/index.html`.

Git Commands Run

- `pwd`
- `git status --short`
- `git branch --show-current`
- `git remote -v`

- `find . -maxdepth 3 -name .git -type d`
- `ls -la`
- `node --check public/puzzles.js`
- `node --check public/game.js`
- `node scripts/validate-puzzles.js`
- `git diff --check`
- `git add ...005 puzzle pool files...`
- `git commit -m "Add puzzle pool and paused round flow"`
- `git switch -c scoring-lower-is-better || git switch scoring-lower-is-better`
- `node --check public/scoring.js`
- `node --check public/game.js`
- `node --check scripts/validate-scoring.js`
- `node scripts/validate-scoring.js`
- `node scripts/validate-puzzles.js`
- `python3 -m http.server 8080 -d public (already running on PID 19283; verified with curl)`

Git Commands To Run If Needed

```
git status --short
git push origin scoring-lower-is-better
```

Screenshots

PUZZLE #001

One Wrong Move

TIME

0.0s

READY

DAILY PUZZLE

MISTAKES 0

DAILY PUZZLE READY

One board. One rule. One wrong move.

Score = rounded-up solving time + 10s per mistake. Lower is better.

The board stays hidden until you open a round briefing.

Start

Intro screen showing scoring explanation

PUZZLE #001

TIME

One Wrong Move

0.6s

ROUND 1 OF 3

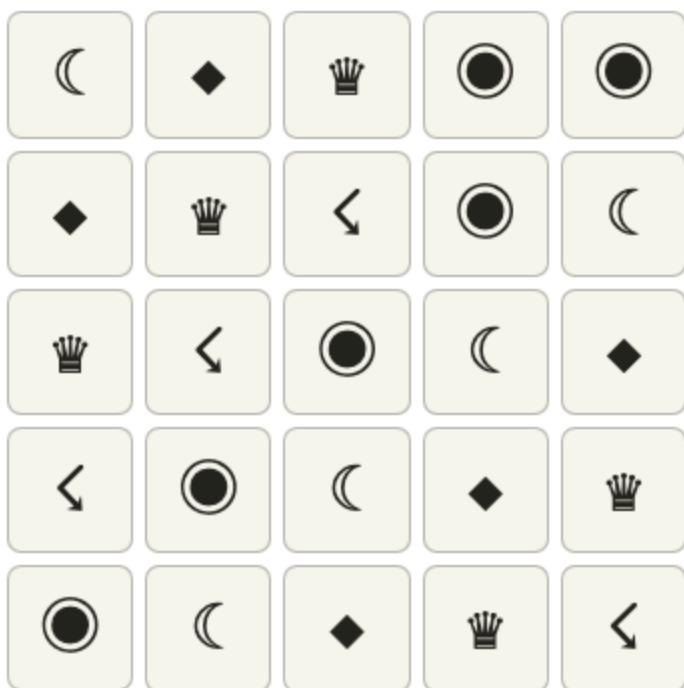
DAILY PUZZLE

MISTAKES 0

ROUND 1: RULE ROWS

Each row uses the same five-symbol recipe, shifted one place. One glyph breaks the row grammar.

Compare rows as sequences, not as pictures. Tap the symbol that does not belong in its row.

**Restart**

Active round screen showing timer still works

PUZZLE #001

TIME

One Wrong Move

0.8s

ROUND 1 OF 3

DAILY PUZZLE

MISTAKES 1

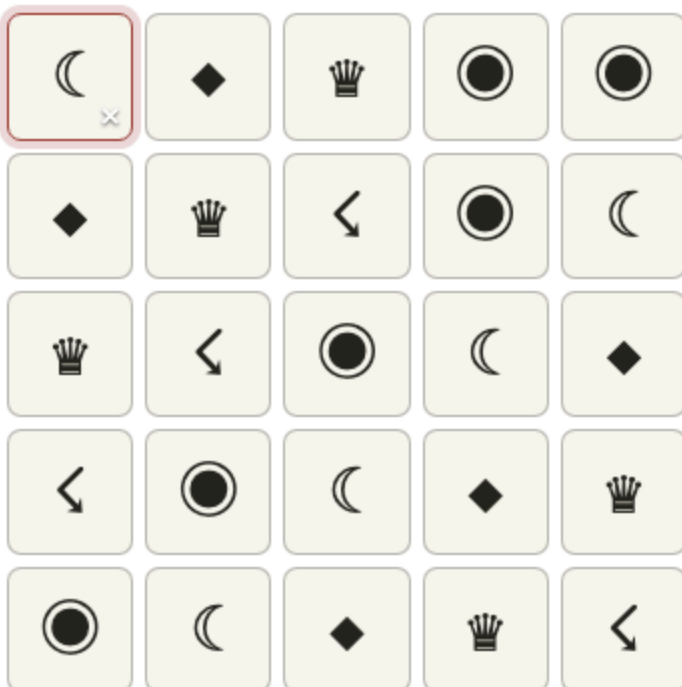
ROUND 1: RULE ROWS

Each row uses the same five-symbol recipe, shifted one place. One glyph breaks the row grammar.

Compare rows as sequences, not as pictures. Tap the symbol that does not belong in its row.

Try again

The row should be a shifted version of the others. Look for the broken recipe, not the rarest symbol.

**Restart**

Wrong-tap state showing mistake count

PUZZLE #001

One Wrong Move

TIME

1.4s

COMPLETE

DAILY PUZZLE

MISTAKES 1

DAILY PUZZLE SOLVED

Solved 3 of 3

Score = rounded-up solving time + 10s per mistake. Lower is better.

SOLVED

3 of 3

ACTIVE TIME

1.4s

BASE TIME

2s

FINAL SCORE

12s

LOWER IS BETTER

Mistakes

1

Penalty

 $1 \times 10s = +10s$

Formula

 $2s + 10s = 12s$

SHARE TEXT

One Wrong Move #001

Score: 12s

Lower is better

Base: 2s

Mistakes: $1 \times 10s = +10s$ 

Round 1: Rule Rows

Share result**Play another mix**

Completion screen showing score breakdown

COMPLETE

DAILY PUZZLE

MISTAKES 1

DAILY PUZZLE SOLVED

Solved 3 of 3

Score = rounded-up solving time + 10s per mistake. Lower is better.

SOLVED

3 of 3

ACTIVE TIME

1.4s

BASE TIME

2s

FINAL SCORE

12s

LOWER IS BETTER

Mistakes	1
Penalty	$1 \times 10s = +10s$
Formula	$2s + 10s = 12s$

SHARE TEXT

One Wrong Move #001
Score: 12s
Lower is better
Base: 2s
Mistakes: $1 \times 10s = +10s$



Round 1: Rule Rows

Share result**Play another mix****Restart**

Share text with new lower-is-better score

COMPLETE

VARIANT 2

MISTAKES 0

DAILY PUZZLE SOLVED

Solved 3 of 3

Score = rounded-up solving time + 10s per mistake. Lower is better.

SOLVED

3 of 3

ACTIVE TIME

0.7s

BASE TIME

1s

FINAL SCORE

1s

LOWER IS BETTER

Mistakes 0

Penalty $0 \times 10s = +0s$ Formula $1s + 0s = 1s$

SHARE TEXT

One Wrong Move #001

Score: 1s

Lower is better

Variant 2

Base: 1s

Mistakes: $0 \times 10s = +0s$ **Share result****Play another mix****Restart**

Variant replay completion with lower-is-better score